PROJECT DESIGN • PROBLEM–SOLUTION FIT

The problem to solve

ServiceNow-Based Employee Laptop Request Application

Laptop requests can become fragmented across forms, emails and follow-ups, making approval and status difficult to track.

01 Unclear submission

Request details may arrive through different channels or be incomplete, creating extra clarification work.

02 Approval delays

Managers need a clear request and an explicit approval action; requests can wait when the hand-off is unclear.

03 Limited visibility

Employees may need to contact managers or IT to find out whether a request is pending, approved or rejected.

Problem hypothesis: these issues are plausible for the proposed workflow and should be validated with employees, managers and IT staff.

UNDERSTAND THE PEOPLE

Who experiences the problem?

Different roles need different kinds of clarity and control.

EMPLOYEE / REQUESTER

Needs
- Simple form with clear required fields
- Confirmation after submission
- Understandable status and next steps

Pain if unresolved
- Re-entering or clarifying information
- Repeatedly asking for updates

DEPARTMENT MANAGER

Needs
- Relevant request details in one place
- Clear approve/reject action
- Enough context to make a decision

Pain if unresolved
- Requests buried in messages
- Unclear ownership or pending items

IT ADMINISTRATOR

Needs
- Consistent request records
- Approval outcome and requester details
- A reliable hand-off for fulfilment

Pain if unresolved
- Chasing missing details
- Manually checking request progress

Primary users: employees submitting requests and managers approving them. IT administrators support request handling and fulfilment.

PROPOSED RESPONSE

How the solution fits the problem

A single ServiceNow-based workflow connects request submission, approval and communication.

PROBLEM	SOLUTION CAPABILITY	EXPECTED VALUE
Incomplete or inconsistent request details	Record Producer / request form with required fields and validation	More consistent records and fewer clarification loops
Approval hand-off is hard to follow	Flow Designer creates/routes approval and records the decision	Clearer manager action and visible approval outcome
Employee is unsure what happens next	Status updates and email notifications at key workflow points	Fewer manual follow-ups and clearer next steps

FIT ASSUMPTIONS AND NEXT STEPS

What must be true for this solution to work?

Keep the initial scope focused, then validate the fit with real users.

In the initial project scope

- Submit laptop request through ServiceNow
- Validate and create request record
- Route manager approval
- Notify relevant users and expose request status

Not assumed unless configured

- Automatic laptop inventory integration
- Procurement or delivery tracking
- External APIs, AI/ML or separate databases
- Guaranteed reduction in processing time

VALIDATION QUESTIONS

1. How do employees submit laptop requests today? 2. Where do requests get delayed? 3. How do users check status? 4. What information does a manager need to approve?

Success signals to measure: fewer incomplete submissions, clear approval status, fewer status-chasing messages, and timely notifications.